▼ GLASSHOUSE



MIXED FEELINGS

The INDIA bloc's unveiling of its VP candidate B. Sudershan Reddy at the Samajwadi Party HQ in Lucknow on Aug. 26 was a grand affair. SP chief Akhilesh Yadav and UP Congress president Ajay Rai led the show, flanked by senior leaders of both parties. But one man missed the show: Kishori Lal Sharma, the man who defeated Smriti Irani and reclaimed Amethi for the Congress in last year's LS polls. He had come to the venue, only to be stopped by the security guards at the entrance. Offended, Sharma left, even as Akhilesh and Rai rushed to placate him. The party, though, moved on, celebrating the SP's youngest MP Iqra Hasan's birthday. As she cut a cake amid cheers, Akhilesh pressed a crisp Rs 100 note into her hand as *shagun*. At least one person left happy.

Illustrations by **SIDDHANT JUMDE**

▼ SPORTS ED

GLOBAL WORK-EX

Determined to host the 2036 Summer Olympics, MoS for sports **Harsh Sanghavi** along with other bureaucrats, among them **Ashwani Kumar**, secretary in the sports department, are busy gathering international expertise on global sports and sporting events. Sanghavi and his team attended the Paris Olympics last year, and also visited London and Los Angeles, cities that have hosted the Olympics. This globetrotting should help the team assess the physical infrastructure, connectivity, economics and even the cultural capital required to host the Games. Sanghavi is also the point of contact for all the multiple international consulting agencies the government has hired to help them pitch and engage with the International Olympic Committee (IOC) on the one hand, and to prep suitable infrastructure for multiple sporting events on the other. Talk about leaving nothing to chance!

